

Instructor Guide

Lesson Metadata

Field	Detail
Path	Digital Independence Path
Course	Course 17: Skills That Pay
Lesson	Lesson 2: Turn a Skill Into a Service
Age range	15–18
Format	Live, instructor-led (video classroom)
Duration	60 minutes
Tools used	Google Docs, Canva, Notion, Email, Spreadsheets
Prerequisites	Course 16 (student has a completed portfolio with at least 2–3 documented skills/projects); Course 17 Lesson 1 (understands the freelance landscape: platforms, client types, basic pricing concepts)
Lesson goal	Each student converts one skill from their Course 16 portfolio into a specific, scoped, repeatable service they could realistically offer

Overview

Lesson 1 gave students the map of the freelance/service landscape — what kinds of paid work exist, who buys them, and roughly how pricing works. This lesson narrows the focus: students take one skill they already have evidence of (from their Course 16 portfolio) and shape it into a **service** — something specific enough that a stranger reading it would immediately understand what they'd get, from whom, and for what.

This is the conceptual hinge of Course 17: "I know Python" is not sellable. "I build a working scoreboard/timer web app for a school club's tournament, delivered in 3 days" is. The lesson does not ask students to set a price yet (that's a later lesson) — it asks them to get the *offer* right first.

All example businesses, clients, and prices used in this lesson are fictional teaching illustrations. No real transaction, business registration, or payment processing is implied or required to complete this lesson.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to: 1. Explain the difference between a "skill" and a "service" in their own words. 2. Identify at least two possible services hidden inside one of their existing Course 16 skills. 3. Draft one clear service statement using the skill → service formula (skill + specific output + specific audience + scope boundary). 4. Recognize and avoid two common beginner mistakes: trying to serve "everyone," and believing a service must be totally unique to be valid.

Materials & Prep (before class)

- Open a fresh **Google Doc** titled "Skill → Service Demo" for the live demo (see Teaching Sequence, Step 2).
- Have the **Course 16 portfolio template** on hand (Notion or Docs, whichever the cohort used) — you will pull real skill entries from a student's portfolio during discussion, with their permission, or use the fictional "Jordan R." example from the Worksheet if no student volunteers.
- Pre-load the **Worksheet** ("Skill-to-Service Builder") in Notion or as a Google Doc/Sheet so students can duplicate it individually.
- Have a blank **Spreadsheet** tab ready if you want to log service ideas from the class as a shared brainstorm list (optional, good for larger cohorts).
- Review the fictional Jordan R. example in the Student Lesson and Worksheet so you can reference it fluently without reading it cold.
- Confirm every student can access their own Course 16 portfolio document before class starts — send a reminder email or chat message 24 hours prior if needed.

Teaching Sequence (60 minutes)

1. Open & Frame (5 min)

- Quick recap question: "Last lesson, we mapped out the freelance landscape. Today: who here could tell me, in one sentence, what work you'd actually offer someone?" Take 1–2 quick verbal answers — expect vague ones ("coding stuff," "design"). Don't correct yet, just note them; you'll return to them at the end.
- State the goal plainly: "By the end of today, you will have one sentence that describes an actual service you could offer — specific enough that if I read it, I'd know exactly what I'm getting."

2. Skill vs. Service — Direct Teaching + Live Demo (15 min)

- **Core distinction (write on shared screen / Google Doc):**
- A **skill** is something you can do. ("I know HTML/CSS.")
- A **service** is a packaged version of that skill that is:
 - **Specific** — a defined output, not an open-ended ability
 - **Scoped** — has a clear boundary on what's included and what isn't
 - **Repeatable** — you could do it again for a different client without reinventing it each time
- Formula to display: **Service = Skill + Specific Output + Specific Audience + Scope Boundary**

- **Live demo** — in the prepared Google Doc, work through a fictional student profile out loud:
- Present: "Maya, from her Course 16 portfolio, has: (1) a personal portfolio site built with HTML/CSS/basic JS, (2) a Canva-designed Instagram template pack she made for her robotics club, (3) a short project where she cleaned and charted data in Spreadsheets for a school survey."
- Think aloud, applying the formula to skill (1): "Skill: HTML/CSS. Output: a small website. Audience: who actually needs a small website and can't easily get one? Not big companies — small student clubs, a tutor, a local youth sports team. Scope: how many pages, how long, what's NOT included (no e-commerce, no ongoing hosting management)." Land on: **Service Idea A — "I build simple 3–5 page websites for student clubs and small community groups, delivered in one week, with one round of revisions included."**
- Repeat quickly for skill (2): **Service Idea B — "I design a matching set of 5 Instagram graphic templates (Canva) for a school club or small student group, so they can post consistent content without redesigning each one."**
- Point out: same student, two different services, from two different skills — and neither claims to serve "everyone."

3. Guided Discussion (10 min)

Ask and take answers from several students (cold-call gently if needed): - "What's different between 'I know graphic design' and Maya's Service Idea B?" - "Why did we say 'student clubs and small community groups' instead of just 'businesses'?" - "What would happen if Maya's website service had no scope boundary — no page limit, no revision limit?" - "Could two students both offer 'websites for clubs' and still both be doing something valid? Why?"

4. Common Misconceptions — Address Directly (5 min)

Call these out explicitly, even if no student says them aloud — they are near-universal at this age:

- **"My service has to work for everyone, or I'm limiting myself."** Correction: The opposite is true. A service aimed at "everyone" reads as aimed at no one — it's what makes "I do graphic design" impossible to say yes to. Naming a specific audience (small clubs, tutors, local shops, other students) makes it *easier* to get a first client, not harder. You can always expand later once you have proof it works.
- **"My service has to be totally unique or no one will notice me."** Correction: Almost no beginner service is unique — website-building and graphic design services already exist everywhere. What makes it work isn't novelty, it's specificity and reliability: a clear, scoped offer that's easy to say yes to, delivered well. Uniqueness can come later, from your style or your track record — it's not a requirement to start.

5. Independent Activity (20 min)

Students work in the Worksheet (Notion or Docs) individually: - **Step 1:** List 2–3 skills from their Course 16 portfolio in the skills inventory table. - **Step 2:** For each skill, brainstorm 1–2 possible services in the brainstorm table (skill / possible service / who needs this). - **Step 3:** Pick their strongest option and write it as a single service statement using the formula, filling in the "my chosen service" template. - Circulate (or monitor chat/breakout rooms) while students work — this is where most 1:1 coaching happens. See Troubleshooting below.

6. Share & Close (5 min)

- Ask 2–3 volunteers to read their service statement aloud (or paste in chat).
- For each, do a 10-second gut check as a class: "Is it specific? Is it scoped? Could they do it again for someone else?"
- Close: "You now have one sentence that says what you'd actually offer. Next lesson, we start figuring out what to charge for it — but you can't price something fuzzy, so today's work is the foundation."
- Remind students their service statement will be needed for the next lesson and should be saved in their portfolio/planning doc.

Discussion Questions (use during Step 3 or as backup/extension)

1. Why is "I'm good with computers" not a service, even though it's true for a lot of students?
2. If two students at Lumexa both decide to build websites for clubs, has either of them made a mistake? Why or why not?
3. What's one skill from your own portfolio that could become more than one service, like Maya's HTML/CSS skill did?
4. Why do we include a scope boundary ("what's NOT included") in a service statement instead of just describing what IS included?

Student Difficulties & Troubleshooting

What you'll see	Likely cause	What to do
Student writes a service statement that's just their skill restated ("I do web design for people")	Hasn't applied output/audience/scope yet	Ask: "If I said yes right now, what exactly would I receive, and by when?" Have them answer that out loud, then write down their own answer.
Student picks an audience that's too broad ("small businesses")	Defaulting to landscape-lesson language instead of narrowing further	Ask: "Of all small businesses, who would actually say yes to a 16-year-old? Who do you already have some connection to or credibility with?" Push toward clubs, peers, family-adjacent contacts, local micro-organizations.
Student freezes because they think their idea has "been done before"	Uniqueness misconception	Point back to the Canva/website example — remind them two students can offer similar services and both succeed. Redirect focus to specificity, not originality.
Student can't decide between two service ideas	Both are genuinely reasonable	Ask which one they could describe in one sentence <i>right now</i> without hesitating — that's usually the stronger, clearer one to start with. Reassure them the other idea isn't lost, just parked.
Student's scope has no boundary at all ("as many revisions as needed")	Hasn't yet connected scope to sustainability	Ask: "If you had 5 clients at once, could you actually do 'unlimited revisions' for all of them?" Have them add a concrete number or limit.

What you'll see	Likely cause	What to do
Student wants to list a skill they don't actually have portfolio evidence for	Reaching beyond Course 16 material	Redirect: "Let's build from what you've already proven you can do — that's what makes this believable to a client." Keep them anchored to their real portfolio.

How to Review Student Work

Check each student's final service statement for: - [] **Specific output** — names a concrete deliverable (a website, a template set, a document, a chart), not an open-ended ability - [] **Named audience** — a defined type of person or group, not "anyone" or "everyone" - [] **Scope boundary** — states a limit (number of pages/items, timeframe, or what's excluded) - [] **Traceable to Course 16** — the underlying skill is one they have actual portfolio evidence for - [] **Plausible for their age/context** — a real service a teen could credibly deliver without needing adult business infrastructure they don't have

If a statement is missing 2 or more of these, have the student revise it before the next lesson using written feedback (email or a comment in their doc) rather than requiring an in-class redo.

Lesson Close / Transition

Restate the thread across the course: Lesson 1 = landscape, Lesson 2 = your specific offer, next lesson = what it's worth. Confirm every student leaves with a saved, written service statement — this is the required input for Lesson 3 and should not be treated as optional homework.